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15 MAY 1952
SUPERSEDING
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1 October 1951

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

POTATOES, WHITE; CANNED

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Styles.—Canned white potatoes shall be of the following styles as specified (see 6.2):

Style I. —Whole
Style II. —Sliced
Style III.—Diced
Style IV.—Shoestring
Style V. —Pieces

1.2 Sizes.—Canned white potatoes of style I, whole, shall be of the following sizes or combination of sizes as specified:

Size 1 (tiny). —1 inch or less in diameter.

Size 2 (small). —Over 1 inch to, and including, 1½ inches in diameter.

Size 3 (medium).—Over 1½ inches in diameter.

1.3 Grades.—Canned white potatoes shall be of the following grades as specified:

Fancy (Grade A)
Standard (Grade C)

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications. — There are no other specifications applicable to this specification except those referenced in section 7 by individual departments.

(Copies of Federal specifications and the Federal Specifications Index may be obtained upon application, accompanied by money order, coupon, or cash to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C., or to the GSA Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, and Seattle. Prices may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents or from the GSA Regional Offices.)

2.2 Other publications. — The following publications, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Governmental:

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations for its Enforcement.

Nongovernmental:

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists.

(Copies of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations for its Enforcement may be obtained upon application, accompanied by money order, coupon, or cash to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C. *Prices* may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents.

(Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists is published by the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists, P. O. Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington 4, D. C.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials. — Canned white potatoes shall be prepared from sound white potatoes

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and shall be of the latest pack, unless otherwise specified.

3.2 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act.—All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, and regulations promulgated thereunder.

3.3 Head space and drained weights.—The maximum head space allowable for the respective sizes of containers shall be as shown in table I. Drained weights shall be determined in accordance with the method described in 4.3.2, and the average thus obtained shall be not less than the drained weight specified in table I.

TABLE I.—*Head space and drained weights*

Container size or designation	Maximum head space allowable (measured from top of double seam)	Drained weight (see 3.3.1)
	16ths of an inch	*Ounces*
No. 2	9.7	13
No. 2½	9.9	18
No. 10	13.6	74

3.3.1 Compliance with drained weight requirements shall be determined by averaging all containers examined from each lot offered for delivery, provided the range of variability is within the limits of good packing practices.

3.4 Description of grades.—Unless otherwise specified, the interpretation of requirements (descriptive terms) contained in 1.1, 1.2, 1.3, 3.5, and 3.6 shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Grades of Canned White Potatoes in effect on the date of invitation for bids.

(Copies of these standards may be obtained, without charge, from the U. S. Department of Agriculture, Washington 25, D. C.)

3.5 Fancy (Grade A). — Canned white potatoes of this grade shall possess similar varietal characteristics; shall possess a good color; shall be practically free from defects; shall possess a good texture; shall possess a normal flavor and odor; and, within the limits prescribed in the United States Standards for Grades of Canned White Potatoes, shall be practically uniform in size and shape, or fairly uniform in size and shape.

3.6 Standard (Grade C).—Canned white potatoes of this grade shall possess similar varietal characteristics; shall possess a fairly good color; shall be fairly uniform in size and shape; shall be fairly free from defects; shall possess a fairly good texture; and shall possess a normal flavor and odor.

3.7 Workmanship.—Canned white potatoes shall be processed under sanitary conditions and in accordance with good commercial practice. The product shall be sufficiently processed by heat to assure preservation in hermetically sealed containers, either tin or glass, as specified. Containers shall be sound and clean. Cans shall be free from rust and serious dents, and the ends shall be flat or concave.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling.—Samples of finished products covered by this specification and samples of any materials, components, or constituents entering into the preparation of the finished products may be taken at any time by the Government inspector to determine compliance with the requirements.

4.2 Inspection.

4.2.1 *General.*—Inspection shall be made by the procuring agency or a duly authorized representative, at the time and place designated by the procuring agency. It may be made at the site of manufacture, both during and after processing, at any suitable point in transit, or after delivery to the point of destination.

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4.2.2 *Factory inspection.*—The passing as satisfactory of any detail of processing or materials shall not relieve the contractor of responsibility for faulty workmanship or materials which may be discovered at any time prior to final acceptance.

4.2.3 *Final inspection.*—Unless otherwise specified, final inspection shall be made after delivery to the point of destination (see 6.4 and 6.5).

4.3 **Tests.**

4.3.1 *Chemical analyses.* — Unless otherwise specified, chemical analyses, if required by the purchaser, shall be made in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists in effect on the date of the invitations for bids or in accordance with methods that give equivalent results.

4.3.2 *Determination of drained weights.*— Drained weights of canned white potatoes shall be determined by emptying the contents of the container in such manner as to distribute the product evenly upon a U. S. Standard No. 8 circular sieve of proper diameter containing 8 meshes to the inch (0.0937-inch, ± 3 percent square openings). Without disturbing the product, the sieve shall be so inclined as to facilitate drainage and the product shall be allowed to drain for 2 minutes. The drained weight shall be the weight of the sieve and white potatoes less the weight of the dry sieve. A sieve 8 inches in diameter shall be used for containers the equivalent of No. 2½ cans and smaller, and a sieve 12 inches in diameter shall be used for No. 10 size containers.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 **Packaging.**—Unless otherwise specified, commercial packaging is acceptable.

5.2 **Labeling.**—Any commercial labeling, or additional labeling as specified, that complies with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, and regulations promulgated thereunder, is acceptable.

5.3 **Packing.**—Unless otherwise specified, the product shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to the point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.4 **Marking for shipment.**—Unless otherwise specified, shipping containers shall be marked with the name of the product, quantity and size of packages in the container as defined by the contract or order under which the shipment is made, the name of the contractor, the number of the contract or order, the month and year of processing, and other pertinent information as specified by individual agencies.

6. NOTES

6.1 **Ordering data.**—Invitations for bids should state the style, size of Style I, Whole; and grade of product and the size and kind of packaging required.

6.2 This specification does not include all of the styles and grades of canned white potatoes that are commercially available but is intended to cover the styles and grades that are normally suitable for Federal Government requirements.

6.3 **Bid samples.**—If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated.

6.4 **Contractor's inspection.** — The contractor should be required to assure that the product conforms with the specification prior to submission to the Government for final inspection.

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6.5 Destination inspection. — When the finished product has been inspected and passed at point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for condition and quantity only.

6.6 Transportation description

6.6.1 *Transportation description applicable to these items is:*

Vegetables, canned or preserved.
* In barrels or boxes, in metal cans in crates, or in packages 223, 242 or 906. Carload weight 36,000 pounds.
* In barrels or boxes, or in metal cans in crates.
Truckload weight 36,000 pounds.
In glass in crates.
Carload weight 36,000 pounds.
Truckload weight 36,000 pounds.

NOTE.—Package numbers referred to above are defined in the current issue of the Consolidated Freight Classification.

Patent notice.—When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

7. DEPARTMENTAL REQUIREMENTS

7.1 The following specifications and standard, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, and special requirements, form a part of this specification for purchases made under this specification by the respective departments.

7.2 Army, Navy, and Air Force.

7.2.1 *Applicable specifications and standard.*

Federal Specifications:

NN–B–621—Boxes; Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.

NN–B–631—Boxes; Wood, Wirebound, for Domestic Shipment.

LLL–B–631—Boxes; Fiber, Corrugated (for Domestic Shipment).

LLL–B–636—Boxes; Fiber, Solid (for Domestic Shipment).

Military Specifications:

MIL–P–1501—Packaging of Canned Subsistence Items, Overseas Shipment.

MIL–P–10225—Packaging of Glass Containers, One-Gallon Capacity and Smaller, for other than Medicinal Products, for Domestic Shipment.

Military Standard:

MIL–STD–129—Marking of Shipments.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring agency or as directed by the contracting officer. Both the title and identifying number or symbol should be stipulated when requesting copies.)

7.2.2 *Packing for domestic shipment.*

7.2.2.1 *Glass containers.*—Glass containers shall be packed in accordance with Military Specification MIL–P–10225.

7.2.2.2 *Cans.*—The cans of the product, arranged as specified in Military Specification MIL–P–1501, shall be packed on end in snug-fitting corrugated or solid fiberboard, nailed wood, or wirebound wood boxes constructed in accordance with Federal Specifications LLL–B–631, LLL–B–636, NN–B–621, and NN–B–631, respectively. Flaps of fiberboard containers shall be securely sealed with an adhesive commercially used for the specific product being packed applied throughout the entire area of contact between the flaps or by a combination of stitching one set of flaps prior to packing

* Preferred method of shipment to obtain lowest transportation charge.

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and sealing the other flaps with the adhesive. When flaps are stitched, the stitches shall be distributed so as to fasten all flaps securely together over the entire area of contact between the inner and outer flaps and to prevent lifting of free edges and corners of outer flaps.

7.2.3 *Packaging and packing for overseas shipment.*—The product shall be packaged and packed as specified in Military Specification MIL–P–1501.

7.2.4 *Labeling and marking.*

7.2.4.1 *Cans for overseas shipment.*—The cans of the product shall be labeled as specified in Military Specification MIL–P–1501.

7.2.4.2 *Shipping containers.*—In addition to the marking specified herein and any special marking required by the contract or order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–129.

7.2.5 *Ordering data.* — Procurement documents should specify whether shipment is to be packaged, packed, labeled and marked for domestic or overseas destination (see 5, 7.2.2, 7.2.3, and 7.2.4).

NAVY INTEREST: *MC* Md S

This specification is a part of Section IV, Part 5, of the Federal Standard Stock Catalog.

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